

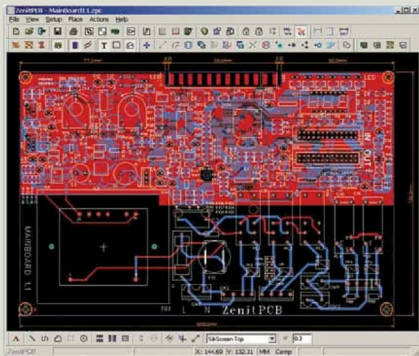


Fig. 5: Sample board on ZenitPCB

OS X platforms. It uses an integrated environment for all the stages of the

design process—schematic capture, PCB layout, Gerber file generation/

visualisation and library editing. It also has a 3D PCB viewing function.

DipTrace. This tool has an intuitive user interface. Step-by-Step tutorials are available on its website. In the free version, functionality of the full package is available, except that it is limited to 300 pins, non-commercial use and two signal layers. Also, drawing and routing the schematics and PCBs is very easy.

Some limitations

The limitation of 800 pins creates a border line between hobby projects and professional projects. Starting a project in ZenitPCB and drawing the circuit diagram might be very easy but you may not find all the components required for your project. Some useful features like auto place component and auto router are missing, but overall it's a great tool. Check out for yourself from this month's EFY DVD! ●

The author is a tech correspondent at EFY

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